

TextEditor+

User Manual

Version 1.1.0

A lightweight code and text editor for macOS, Windows and Linux

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1 Introduction

TextEditor+ is a fast, lightweight editor for code and plain text. It is the native desktop version of Web TextEditor, the browser-based editor on sjwrc.com, and keeps its look and features while adding your operating system's own file dialogs, printing, find and replace, and more.

TextEditor+ is built for quick edits: it opens instantly, edits one file per window, and stays out of your way. Its main features are:

- **Syntax highlighting** for HTML (including embedded `<script>` and `<style>` sections), CSS, JavaScript, C and C++, chosen automatically from the file name.
- **Two colour themes**: Dracula (dark) and Eclipse (light).
- **Comfortable editing**: line numbers, current-line highlight, automatic indentation, word wrap and Go to Line.
- **Find and replace** with case matching, whole-word search, regular expressions and back-references.
- **Faithful saving**: every file keeps its line endings and encoding, and saves are atomic, so a failed save never leaves a half-written file.
- **Printing** of a whole file or a selection, in colours suited to paper.
- **Safeguards** against opening devices, binary files and very large files by accident.

1.1 About this manual

This manual covers TextEditor+ 1.1.0. Keyboard shortcuts are given for macOS first and for Windows and Linux second, for example `⌘S` / `Ctrl+S`. On a Mac, `⌘` is the Command key, `⌥` is Option, `⇧` is Shift and `⌃` is Control. Menu commands are written as **File > Save As…**.

2 Installing TextEditor+

2.1 macOS

TextEditor+ for macOS is distributed as a disk image, `TextEditor+-1.1.0.dmg`, for Apple Silicon (M-series) Macs.

1. Double-click `TextEditor+-1.1.0.dmg` to open it.
2. Drag **TextEditor+** onto the **Applications** folder shown in the same window.
3. Eject the disk image.

The current build is not notarised by Apple, so macOS blocks the first launch with a message that it cannot verify the app. To open it the first time, either:

- **Control-click** (or right-click) TextEditor+ in the Applications folder, choose **Open**, and confirm with Open; or
- try to open it normally, then go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security** and click Open Anyway.

You only need to do this once. After that, TextEditor+ opens like any other app.

2.2 Windows

TextEditor+ for Windows is a portable app for 64-bit Windows 10 and 11, distributed as a zip file, `TextEditor+-1.1.0-windows-x64.zip`. It needs no installation.

1. Extract the whole folder from the zip file to wherever you like: your Documents folder, the desktop or a USB stick. Don't run TextEditor+ from inside the zip file.
2. Double-click `TextEditor+.exe` in the extracted folder.

The program isn't signed, so the first time you run it Windows SmartScreen may say "Windows protected your PC". Click More info, then Run anyway.

The portable version keeps its settings in the `settings` folder next to `TextEditor+.exe` rather than in the Windows registry, so they travel with the folder. That folder must be writable for settings to be saved. If you delete the `settings` folder, TextEditor+ stores its settings in the registry like an installed program. To remove TextEditor+, delete its folder.

2.3 Linux

There are no prebuilt packages for Linux yet. TextEditor+ can be built from source with Qt 6.4 or later, CMake 3.21 or later and a C++17 compiler; the `README.md` file in the source code has step-by-step instructions.

> **Note** Everything in this manual applies to all three platforms unless a section says otherwise. A few behaviours, such as dropping files on the Dock icon, exist only on macOS.

3 A tour of the window

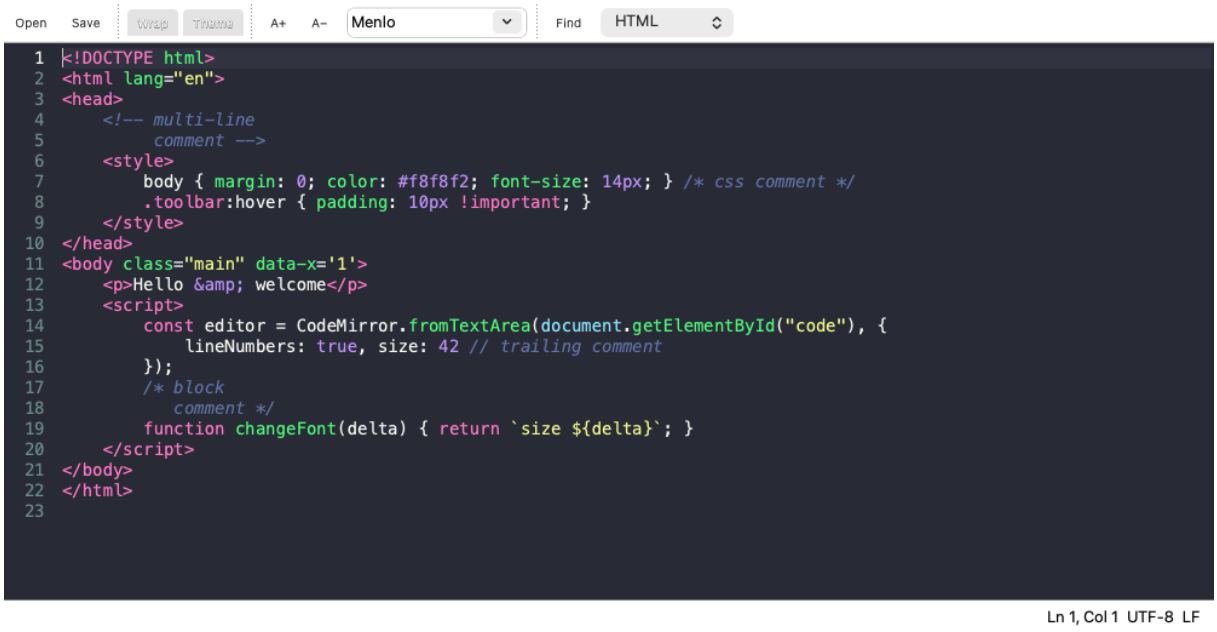


Figure 1: TextEditor+ editing an HTML file in the dark (Dracula) theme.

The TextEditor+ window (Figure 1) has three parts.

3.1 The toolbar

From left to right, the toolbar holds:

Control	What it does
Open	Opens a file (section 4).
Save	Saves the current file (section 9).
Wrap	Turns word wrap on or off. Highlighted when on.
Theme	Switches between the dark and light themes. Highlighted when the dark theme is on.
A+ A−	Makes the text larger or smaller.
Font box	Chooses the editor font. Only monospaced (fixed-width) fonts are listed.
Find	Opens the find bar (section 6).
Language box	Chooses the syntax highlighting (section 7).

3.2 The editing area

The editing area shows your text with line numbers on the left. The line containing the cursor is highlighted, and its line number is drawn in a brighter colour.

3.3 The status bar

The status bar along the bottom shows, from left to right:

- the cursor position, as Ln (line) and Col (column);
- the file's text encoding, UTF-8 or Latin-1;
- the file's line endings, LF (macOS and Linux style) or CRLF (Windows style).

Short messages, such as "Saved notes.txt", also appear briefly on the left of the status bar.

3.4 The title bar

The title bar shows the name of the open file, or Untitled for a new one. When the file has unsaved changes, macOS shows a dot in the window's close button, and Windows and Linux add an asterisk (*) after the name.

4 Opening files

TextEditor+ edits one file per window. Opening a file replaces the one currently shown; if that file has unsaved changes, you are asked whether to save them first (section 9.3).

4.1 Ways to open a file

Open dialog
Choose **File > Open…**, press ⌘O / Ctrl+O, or click Open in the toolbar. The dialog starts

in the folder of the file you have open. Use the file-type menu in the dialog to show only text, web or C/C++ files.

Drag onto the window
Drag a file from Finder, File Explorer or your file manager and drop it anywhere on the editing area.

Drag onto the Dock icon (macOS)
Drop a file on the TextEditor+ icon in the Dock. This works whether or not TextEditor+ is already running.

Open With (macOS)
In Finder, Control-click a file and choose **Open With > TextEditor+**. TextEditor+ is listed for every file but never makes itself the default app for any file type, so double-clicking files keeps opening them in your usual apps.

Command line
Pass a file name when starting the program, for example `TextEditor+ notes.txt`. Run `TextEditor+ --help` for the options, or `--version` to print the version.

When you open a file, TextEditor+ picks the syntax highlighting from its file extension (section 7).

4.2 Safeguards when opening

To protect you from mistakes, TextEditor+ checks each file before opening it:

- **Only regular files are opened.** Folders, devices and pipes are refused with a message, because reading them could never finish.
- **Binary files need confirmation.** If a file contains NUL bytes, which text files do not, TextEditor+ warns that it appears to be binary and asks whether to open it anyway.
- **Large files need confirmation.** Files over 50 MB can make the editor slow, so you are asked before they open.
- **Very large files are refused.** Files over 512 MB are not opened at all, because the whole file is held in memory.

> **Caution** Saving a binary file from a text editor usually damages it. Open binary files only to look at them, and close them without saving.

4.3 Encodings

TextEditor+ reads files as UTF-8, the standard encoding for modern text. If a file is not valid UTF-8, it is opened as Latin-1 (ISO 8859-1) instead, the status bar shows Latin-1, and a message "Not valid UTF-8: opened as Latin-1" appears for a few seconds. Section 9 explains how the encoding is kept when you save.

5 Editing text

TextEditor+ supports the standard editing commands of your platform: typing, selecting with the mouse or with ⇧ and the arrow keys, and the usual clipboard commands.

5.1 The Edit menu

Command	macOS	Windows / Linux	Notes
Undo	⌘Z	Ctrl+Z	Unavailable when there is nothing to undo.
Redo	⇧⌘Z	Ctrl+Y or Ctrl+⇧Z	
Cut	⌘X	Ctrl+X	
Copy	⌘C	Ctrl+C	
Paste	⌘V	Ctrl+V	Always pastes plain text.
Select All	⌘A	Ctrl+A	

5.2 Automatic indentation

When you press Return / Enter, the new line starts with the same indentation (spaces and tabs) as the line above, so code stays lined up. Tab stops are four characters wide.

5.3 Go to Line

Choose **Edit > Go to Line…** or press ⌘L / Ctrl+L, type a line number, and press Return. The dialog shows the range of valid line numbers, and the line you choose is scrolled to the middle of the window.

6 Find and replace

6.1 Finding text

Choose **Edit > Find…**, press ⌘F / Ctrl+F, or click Find in the toolbar. The find bar opens above the text. If you had selected some text on a single line, it is filled in for you.

As you type, TextEditor+ jumps to the first match from the cursor. Then:

- press Return or click Next to go to the next match;
- press ⇧Return or click Previous to go to the previous match;
- press Esc or click × to close the find bar.

You can also use **Edit > Find Next** (⌘G / F3) and **Edit > Find Previous** (⇧⌘G / ⇧F3) with the find bar closed. Searching wraps around: after the last match it continues from the top of the file. If nothing matches, the find bar shows No matches in red.

6.2 Search options

Match case Only finds text with the same capitalisation; “Hello” no longer matches “hello”.

Whole word Only finds complete words; “cat” no longer matches inside “concatenate”.

Regex Treats the search text as a regular expression (section 6.4).

6.3 Replacing text

Choose **Edit** > **Replace…** or press `⌥⌘F` on macOS, `Ctrl+H` on Windows and most Linux desktops, or `Ctrl+R` on KDE. The find bar opens with the cursor in the Replace with box. Then:

- Replace (or `Return` in the Replace with box) replaces the selected match and moves on to the next one;
- Replace All replaces every match in the file and reports how many it replaced.

A Replace All can be undone in one step with **Edit** > **Undo**.

6.4 Regular expressions

With Regex ticked, the search text is a Perl-compatible regular expression. For example:

Pattern	Finds
`\d+`	one or more digits, such as 42
`colou?r`	“color” or “colour”
`^\s+$`	lines that contain only spaces or tabs
`(\w+)@(\w+)`	a word, an @ sign and another word

In the Replace with box, `\1`, `\2` and so on insert the text matched by the first, second, … group in parentheses. For example, searching for `(\w+)@(\w+)` and replacing with `\2 at \1` turns `alice@example` into `example at alice`.

If the pattern is not a valid regular expression, the find bar shows Invalid pattern and nothing is searched or replaced.

> **Note** Matches cannot span more than one line.

7 Syntax highlighting

TextEditor+ colours keywords, strings, numbers, comments and other parts of the text to make code easier to read. The highlighting language is chosen from the file extension when you open or save a file:

Language	File extensions
HTML	`.html .htm .xhtml .xml .svg .vue`
CSS	`.css .scss .less`
JavaScript	`.js .mjs .cjs .jsx .ts .tsx .json`
C	`.c .h`
C++	`.cpp .cc .cxx .hpp .hh .hxx .ino`
Plain Text	anything else

In HTML files, the contents of `<script>` and `<style>` sections are highlighted as JavaScript and CSS.

To choose a language yourself, use the **Language** menu or the language box in the toolbar. Your choice applies until you open another file. Saving under a new name with a recognised extension switches to that extension's language; saving under a name the table doesn't list, such as `notes.txt`, keeps your choice.

8 Customising the view

8.1 Themes

TextEditor+ has a dark theme, Dracula, and a light theme, Eclipse. Switch between them with **View > Dark Theme** or Theme in the toolbar. The dark theme is used the first time you start TextEditor+.

8.2 Word wrap

With word wrap on, long lines are wrapped to fit the window. With it off, they run off to the right and you scroll sideways to see them. Toggle it with **View > Word Wrap**, ⌥Z / Alt+Z, or Wrap in the toolbar. Word wrap only changes how lines are displayed, never the file itself.

8.3 Font and text size

Choose a font from the font box in the toolbar; only monospaced fonts are listed, so columns of code stay aligned. To change the text size:

Action	macOS	Windows / Linux
Zoom In	⌘= or ⌘+, or A+	Ctrl+= or Ctrl++, or A+
Zoom Out	⌘−, or A−	Ctrl+−, or A−
Actual Size	⌘0	Ctrl+0

You can also hold ⌘ / Ctrl and turn the mouse wheel, or scroll on a trackpad. Text sizes range from 6 to 72 points.

8.4 What TextEditor+ remembers

When you close the window, TextEditor+ remembers its size and position, the font and text size, the theme and the word-wrap setting, and restores them the next time it starts. Section 13 explains how to reset them.

9 Saving files

9.1 Save and Save As

- **File > Save** (⌘S / Ctrl+S, or Save in the toolbar) saves the file under its current name. A new, untitled file asks for a name first.

- **File > Save As…** (⇧⌘S / Ctrl+⇧S) saves under a new name. For a new file, the dialog suggests `untitled.txt` in your Documents folder.

9.2 How files are saved

TextEditor+ is careful to change only what you edited:

- **Line endings are kept.** A file with Windows-style (CRLF) line endings is saved with CRLF; anything else with LF. New files use LF.
- **The encoding is kept.** UTF-8 files are saved as UTF-8 and Latin-1 files as Latin-1. Latin-1 can only store 256 different characters, so if you have added a character it can't hold, such as "€" or an emoji, TextEditor+ asks whether to save the file as UTF-8 instead. Choose Cancel to go back and edit the text.
- **Saves are atomic.** The new text is written to a temporary file first and then swapped in. If a save fails, for example because the disk is full, the original file is left untouched and a message explains what went wrong.

9.3 Unsaved changes

If the current file has unsaved changes when you open another file, start a new one, close the window or quit, TextEditor+ asks whether to save them:

Save saves the file, then carries on.

Don't Save / **Discard** throws the changes away, then carries on.

Cancel does nothing, so you can keep editing.

TextEditor+ does not save automatically, so remember to save your work.

10 Printing

Choose **File > Print…** or press ⌘P / Ctrl+P. Your system's print dialog opens. To print only part of the file, select that text first; the print dialog then offers to print just the selection.

The printout always uses the light Eclipse colours, with syntax highlighting, in the editor's current font, so a dark theme never puts white text on a black background on paper.

11 Closing and quitting

11.1 New, Close Window and Quit

File > New (⌘N / Ctrl+N) Clears the window for a new, untitled file.

File > Close Window (⌘W / Ctrl+W) Closes the window.

Quit (⌘Q **, or** Ctrl+Q **on Linux**) Quits TextEditor+. On macOS, Quit is in the **TextEditor+** menu; on Windows and Linux, it's in the **File** menu.

Each of these first asks about unsaved changes (section 9.3).

11.2 On macOS

Like most Mac apps, TextEditor+ keeps running in the Dock after you close its window. To bring the window back, empty and ready for a new file, do any of these:

- click the TextEditor+ icon in the Dock;
- drop a file on the Dock icon, which opens that file;
- choose **File > New** or **File > Open…** from the menu bar.

To stop TextEditor+ completely, choose **TextEditor+ > Quit TextEditor+**, press `⌘Q`, or Control-click the Dock icon and choose **Quit**.

11.3 On Windows and Linux

TextEditor+ has one window, so closing it also quits the program.

12 Keyboard shortcut reference

Command	macOS	Windows / Linux
File		
New	⌘N	Ctrl+N
Open	⌘O	Ctrl+O
Save	⌘S	Ctrl+S
Save As	⇧⌘S	Ctrl+⇧S
Print	⌘P	Ctrl+P
Close Window	⌘W	Ctrl+W
Quit	⌘Q	Ctrl+Q (Linux)
Edit		
Undo / Redo	⌘Z / ⇧⌘Z	Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y
Cut / Copy / Paste	⌘X / ⌘C / ⌘V	Ctrl+X / Ctrl+C / Ctrl+V
Select All	⌘A	Ctrl+A
Find	⌘F	Ctrl+F
Replace	⌥⌘F	Ctrl+H (Ctrl+R on KDE)
Find Next	⌘G	F3
Find Previous	⇧⌘G	⇧F3
Go to Line	⌘L	Ctrl+L
View		
Word Wrap	⌥Z	Alt+Z
Zoom In	⌘=	Ctrl+=
Zoom Out	⌘−	Ctrl+−
Actual Size	⌘0	Ctrl+0
Find bar		
Next match	Return	Enter
Previous match	⇧Return	⇧Enter
Close the find bar	Esc	Esc

13 Troubleshooting

Windows says “Windows protected your PC”

The Windows version isn’t signed. Click More info, then Run anyway, as described in section 2.2.

macOS says it can’t verify TextEditor+ or that it is damaged

This build is not notarised by Apple. Control-click the app and choose **Open**, or use Open Anyway in **System Settings > Privacy & Security**, as described in section 2.1.

A file shows strange characters such as “Ã©”

The file is probably in an encoding other than UTF-8 or Latin-1, such as Windows-1252 or UTF-16. TextEditor+ supports only UTF-8 and Latin-1.

TextEditor+ asks whether to open a file “anyway”

The file is either larger than 50 MB or looks like a binary file. Choose Open if you’re sure, or Cancel. See section 4.

The text runs off the right edge

Word wrap is off. Press `⌥Z` / `Alt+Z` or click Wrap.

The highlighting colours look wrong

Check the language box in the toolbar: a file with an unusual extension may need its language chosen by hand.

On a Mac, I closed the window and TextEditor+ is still in the Dock

That’s normal Mac behaviour. Click the Dock icon to get a new window, or press `⌘Q` to quit.

Resetting all settings

Quit TextEditor+, then delete its settings:

- **macOS:** run `defaults delete com.sjwrc.TextEditor+` in Terminal.
- **Windows (portable version):** empty the `settings` folder in the TextEditor+ folder. If you removed it, delete this registry key instead: `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\sjwrc\TextEditor+`
- **Linux:** delete `~/.config/sjwrc/TextEditor+.conf`.

The next time it starts, TextEditor+ uses its default window size, font, theme and word-wrap setting.

14 About TextEditor+

TextEditor+ 1.1.0 was developed by Sanjeeva Wijeyesakere. To see the version you are running, choose **TextEditor+ > About TextEditor+** on macOS or **Help > About TextEditor+** on Windows and Linux.

TextEditor+ is free software, released under the GNU Affero General Public License, version 3 or later. It is built with the Qt framework, used under the GNU LGPL v3. Bug reports and contributions are welcome on GitHub at github.com/swijeyes.